

Business Requirements Document

ACFS – VBS Pickup Portal (Phase 1)

Version: 1.0

Table of Contents

1. What is the system for?	4
What is explicitly not in Phase 1	4
2. Who all are involved and what they do	4
2.1 Wholesale Freight Forwarder (e.g., AGS, DHL, Mondiale)	4
2.2 Freight Forwarder (downstream / tiered)	4
2.3 Transport Carrier (courier / carrier company)	4
2.4 Customer / One-off party (customer or one-off carrier)	5
2.5 ACFS Staff (admin/operational roles)	5
2.6 Gatehouse	5
3. Entities with key fields and lifecycle states	5
3.1 House Bill (HBL) – the primary tracking unit	5
Key fields (HBL)	5
Lifecycle states (HBL)	6
3.2 Booking (Pickup Booking)	6
Key fields (Booking)	6
Lifecycle states (Booking)	7
3.3 Delivery Order (DO)	7
Key fields (DO)	7
3.4 Delegation	8
Key fields (Delegation)	8
3.5 Pickup Window	8
Key fields (Pickup Window)	8
4. End-to-end flow in simple steps	8
5. Business rules that are non-negotiable	9
5.1 Delegation vs Booking	9
5.2 Booking Preconditions (must be satisfied unless an approved exception applies)	9
5.3 Delivery Order Rules (Release Authority)	9
5.4 Under-bond Rules	10
5.5 Booking Change Rules and Fees	10

6. Business constraints identified	10
7. Dashboards (role-based views to support day-to-day work)	11
7.1 Dashboard: Wholesale Freight Forwarder	11
7.2 Dashboard: Freight Forwarder	11
7.3 Dashboard: Transport Carrier	11
7.4 Dashboard: ACFS Staff (Ops/Admin)	11
7.5 Dashboard: Gatehouse (Read-only)	12
7.6 One-off Booking (No persistent dashboard)	12
8. Things left open (deliberately or possibly overlooked)	12
9. Sources used to compile this BRD	8

1. What is the system for?

The VBS Pickup Portal is a digital portal to help parties involved in ACFS-handled freight to:

- View shipments and House Bills (HBLs) and their latest status information (as available from Maximas data refreshes).
- Delegate responsibility for who will book a pickup (delegation can happen before unpack).
- Book pickup windows/slots once a House Bill is eligible for booking.
- Validate Delivery Orders (DOs) and handle exception/override scenarios.
- Support “Under-bond” and “Free-release” scenarios as part of release-authority rules.
- Provide operational visibility to ACFS staff and Gatehouse (roster view).

The portal co-exists with existing operational systems (e.g., Maximas and external clearance checks). It is not intended to replace Maximas as the system of record.

What is explicitly not in Phase 1

- Replacing Maximas as the system of record.
- Automating ABF/customs clearance or integrating real-time customs checks.
- Full financial reconciliation or refund processing (refund handling may be offline).
- Warehouse execution (pick/pack). Note: Phase 1 DOES include warehouse-side paperwork validation steps inside the portal (DO validation and booking processed marking), but not physical pick/pack execution.

2. Who all are involved and what they do

Roles are contextual per House Bill. The same organisation can appear at different levels for different House Bills.

2.1 Wholesale Freight Forwarder (e.g., AGS, DHL, Mondiale)

- Appears as the top-level wholesale party for many House Bills.
- May provide Delivery Orders to downstream parties (or may be configured as Free Release on a company-to-company basis).
- Needs visibility of House Bills (dashboard) and milestones.

2.2 Freight Forwarder (downstream / tiered)

- Views House Bills and milestones relevant to them (dashboard).
- Delegates booking responsibility to a Carrier or a Customer/one-off party.
- Uploads/ensures required Delivery Orders are available (depending on release rules).

2.3 Transport Carrier (courier / carrier company)

- Receives delegated House Bills and books pickup windows/slots (can book multiple House Bills in one booking).
- Pays booking fees at time of booking (upfront payment).

- Provides truck and driver details for the booking (can be edited until collection).

2.4 Customer / One-off party (customer or one-off carrier)

- Receives a one-off email link from a Freight Forwarder.
- Uses the House Bill reference to complete a one-off booking.
- Does not require a persistent master record in the portal (one-off model).

Note: A one-off party user model conflicts with a “everyone has a dashboard” requirement. This is captured in the Open Items section.

2.5 ACFS Staff (admin/operational roles)

- Views bookings and House Bills to support operational processing.
- Pre-checks Delivery Orders (DOs) and marks them as checked to reduce processing time when the driver arrives.
- Validates DOs again at time of driver arrival if not already checked.
- Verifies Under-bond markings (verification happens outside the portal; portal records verification).
- Applies manual overrides/exceptions to allow booking without required DOs (role restricted).
- Can rebook bookings/HBLs free-of-charge (FOC) in specific situations (elevated privilege).
- Marks a booking as “Processed” once all validations are complete and shipments are good to be picked up.

2.6 Gatehouse Staff

- Read-only access to a daily roster of bookings for the site.
- No system actions required in the portal.

3. Entities with key fields and lifecycle states

3.1 House Bill (HBL) – the primary tracking unit

All bookings, validations and releases operate at House Bill level. A booking may include one or multiple House Bills.

Key fields (HBL)

- House Bill reference (primary reference; used as the reference for one-off booking flows).
- Wholesale Freight Forwarder identifier (top-level relationship).
- Party relationships (tier-2 / downstream relationships may not be guaranteed and may require fallback).
- Milestone/status fields (e.g., vessel, wharf, in yard, unpacked, booked, collected — exact list to be confirmed).
- Under-bond flag (set by Freight Forwarder) and Under-bond Verified flag (set by ACFS staff).

- Release-authority indicators (DO required / free release / under-bond path).
- Latest clearance status field as available from Maximas (display only; no portal-side ABF record to be captured).

Lifecycle states (HBL)

- Created (Inbound / On Vessel)
 - House Bill exists in upstream systems and is visible once data is ingested from Maximas.
- At Wharf / In Yard
 - Shipment has arrived and is under ACFS custody but not yet unpacked.
- Unpacked / Ready for Pickup
 - Goods have been unpacked and are eligible for delegation and booking (subject to release rules).
- Delegated
 - Responsibility for pickup has been delegated to a Carrier or one-off party.
- Booked for Collection
 - House Bill is assigned to a confirmed pickup booking and window.
- Under bond (Optional Path)
 - House Bill marked as under bond by Freight Forwarder.
 - Does not require a Delivery Order.
- Under bond Verified
 - Under bond status manually verified by ACFS (outside system; recorded in portal).
- Collected
 - Goods physically collected.
 - Status reflected in the portal based on Maximas updates.

Note: The latest available status is displayed based on Maximas data refresh cycles. The portal does not maintain a separate ABF clearance record.

3.2 Booking (Pickup Booking)

A booking groups one or more House Bills into a pickup window at a specific site and records payment and validation outcomes.

Key fields (Booking)

- Booking reference / Job or Receipt number (and confirmation message to the booking party).
- Site
- Pickup window (start/end time; can be one of multiple windows per day; overlapping windows supported).
- Included House Bills (one or many).
- Booking party (Carrier / Customer / Freight Forwarder depending on delegation).
- Driver details (name, licence number) – editable until collection.

- Truck details (rego, truck type) – editable until collection.
- Payment status (paid/unpaid) for booking fees and any change/no-show related charges.
- Validation flags: DO checked (per HBL), Under-bond verified (per HBL), Override applied (if any).
- Booking Processed flag (set by ACFS staff once validations are complete and goods are good to be picked up).

Lifecycle states (Booking)

- Draft
 - Booking is being assembled (pickup window selected, House Bills added).
- Booked
 - Pickup window confirmed and booking fee paid.
- Pending Processing
 - Booking exists but required validations are not yet completed.
- Processed
 - All required validations completed (DO checks, under bond verification if applicable).
 - Booking is ready for physical pickup execution.
- Collected / Closed
 - All House Bills in the booking are marked as collected (derived from Maximas status updates).

Note: The “Processed” state is required for Phase 1 (manual action by ACFS staff). “Collected” is ultimately driven by Maximas status updates.

3.3 Delivery Order (DO)

Delivery Orders provide release authority. Rules differ by scenario and hierarchy level.

Key fields (DO)

- Document identifier / file
- Associated House Bill reference(s) (one DO may cover multiple House Bills in some cases)
- Shipment details
- Issuer (e.g., top tier wholesale party or lowest-level party)
- Validation status: Not checked / Checked (manual pre-check or checked at collection time)
- Exception/override marker if booking allowed without DO

Lifecycle states (Booking)

- Not Provided
 - DO not yet uploaded.
 - Booking blocked unless Free Release, under bond, or Override applies.
- Uploaded
 - DO uploaded into the portal.
- Pending Validation

- DO awaiting manual review by ACFS.
- Pre-Checked
 - DO validated before driver arrival (minimum check: House Bill reference match).
- Validated at Pickup
 - DO validated at the time of driver arrival (if not prechecked).
- Not Required
 - DO not required due to Free Release or Under bond.
- Overridden (Exception Applied)
 - Booking allowed without DO using an authorised ACFS override.

3.4 Delegation

Delegation passes responsibility for booking a pickup. It can happen before unpack. Booking cannot be completed until booking preconditions are met.

Key fields (Delegation)

- Delegator party
- Delegatee party (Carrier / Customer / one-off email party)
- Delegation method: direct selection (relationship) OR email link (one-off)
- House Bill(s) delegated
- Any documents attached (if required in that scenario)

3.5 Pickup Window

Pickup windows define available booking times and any cut-offs and fee rules.

Key fields (Pickup Window)

- Site
- Days of week
- Start time and end time
- Booking cut-off time (optional)
- Change cut-off time (optional)
- Heat map reference value (based on number of bookings; used for indication)
- Overlapping windows allowed

4. End-to-end flow in simple steps

1. Shipment and House Bill data becomes available through Maximas update cycles and is displayed in the portal (status freshness depends on Maximas refresh frequency).
2. Wholesale Freight Forwarder / Freight Forwarder / Carrier view their dashboard lists of House Bills and milestones.
3. Freight Forwarder delegates booking responsibility to either (a) a Carrier with an ongoing relationship, or (b) a Customer/one-off party using an email link.

4. The booking party creates a booking by selecting a pickup window and adding one or multiple House Bills.
5. The portal checks booking eligibility rules (unpacked, release conditions satisfied, required authorisations available or exception applied, and storage fees flagged but not necessarily blocking).
6. The portal calculates booking fees and takes upfront payment.
7. The booking party provides driver and truck details (can be changed until change cut-off).
8. ACFS staff use their dashboard to pre-check Delivery Orders (DOs) and mark them as checked (optional pre-work).
9. When the driver arrives, ACFS staff can validate DOs again if needed; for Under-bond House Bills, ACFS staff record "Under-bond Verified".
10. Once validations are complete and the House Bills are good to be picked up, ACFS staff mark the booking as "Processed".
11. Physical pickup processing continues in existing operational systems/processes. When Maximas later marks House Bills as "Collected", the portal will reflect that status on the next refresh.

5. Business rules (essential)

5.1 Delegation vs Booking

- Delegation can happen before unpack.
- Booking cannot be completed until booking preconditions are met.

5.2 Booking Preconditions (must be satisfied unless an approved exception applies)

- Goods must be unpacked (milestone exists in Maximas and fetched into the system).
- Release conditions must be met based on DO / free release / under-bond rules.
- Required authorisations must be available OR an approved override/exception must be applied by an authorised ACFS role.
- Storage fees: must be flagged if due, but booking is not necessarily blocked (existing means handle payment).

5.3 Delivery Order Rules (Release Authority)

- Top-tier release may be either Delivery Order-based or Free Release (for each shipment).
- Intermediate delivery orders may exist but are not required in the 3-level hierarchy approach. (Eg. WFF – **FF** – FF – Carrier/Customer)
- Lowest-level House Bill release authority document is required unless Under-bond applies or an authorised (ACFS) override is applied.
- DOs must be manually validated (prior to or at collection). Minimum check: House Bill reference on the DO matches the House Bill.

5.4 Under-bond Rules

- Under-bond House Bills do not require delivery orders.
- Under-bond status is marked by the Freight Forwarder and must be manually verified by ACFS outside the system; the portal records that verification.

5.5 Booking Change Rules and Fees

- A booking can include one or multiple House Bills.
- Adding a House Bill to an existing booking requires an additional fee for the added House Bill (based on volumetric rules).
- Moving a House Bill between bookings has no fee impact if already paid.
- Removing a House Bill is treated as a partial cancellation; refund handling is not defined in-system and may be handled offline.
- No-shows incur a rebooking fee (configurable).
- Changes after the change cut-off and/or booking cut-off time may incur a fee (if change cut-off and/or booking cut-off is configured).
- Fee types explicitly discussed:
 - Minimum charge + volumetric charge
 - Change cut-off fee (changes after cut-off)
 - Booking cut-off fee (changes after cut-off)
 - Rebooking / no-show fee (no-show → rebooking fee)
- Fee configurability explicitly discussed:
 - Global fee settings preferred for MVP (site/slot overrides add complexity and hence out of scope for this phase)
- ACFS overrides / booking changes can be done fee free (restricted access to feature)

6. Business constraints identified

- Data is not real-time. House Bill status freshness depends on Maximas update cycles.
- House Bill data is most reliable post-unpack, but changes may still occur later due to operational realities (loss/short pick/adjustments).
- Tier-2 freight forwarder relationship sourcing is unresolved and may require a fallback approach.
- ABF/customs checks occur outside the portal. The portal displays the latest available status from Maximas but does not capture an internal ABF clearance record.
- Refund logic is unresolved; partial cancellation refunds are likely handled outside the system in Phase 1.
- Storage fee payment remains managed via existing means; portal may flag due/possible due status.

7. Dashboards (role-based views to support day-to-day work)

Dashboards are required for day-to-day decision-making. The exact metrics and layouts will be refined in discovery, but the following dashboard content is within the known scope and requirements.

7.1 Dashboard: Wholesale Freight Forwarder

- List of House Bills relevant to the wholesale party (lowest-level house bill view).
- Milestones with actual/expected dates (as available from Maximas).
- Ability to identify which House Bills are delegated downstream vs pending delegation (where data exists).
- Visibility of booking status: not booked / booked / processed / collected (processed is portal flag; collected comes from Maximas).
- Optional email notification preferences for milestone/status changes.

Ambiguity: The system's ability to show downstream (tier-2) relationships consistently is unresolved; dashboard may require fallback behaviours.

7.2 Dashboard: Freight Forwarder

- List of House Bills relevant to the freight forwarder.
- Milestones with actual/expected dates.
- Delegation actions: nominate/select a carrier OR send one-off email link for customer/one-off carrier.
- Indicator for release-authority readiness: DO required / free release / under-bond / exception applied (at HBL level).
- Booking overview: House Bills already booked, pending booking eligibility, and booked bookings scheduled by pickup window.
- Optional email notification preferences.

7.3 Dashboard: Transport Carrier

- List of delegated House Bills awaiting booking.
- Create/select pickup windows and assemble bookings with multiple House Bills.
- View booking cut-offs and change cut-offs (if configured).
- Booking fee preview and payment status per booking.
- Driver/truck details management for upcoming bookings.
- No-show and rebooking indicators (where applicable).
- Optional email notification preferences.

7.4 Dashboard: ACFS Staff (Ops/Admin)

- Operational queue of upcoming bookings by site and pickup window.
- Booking detail view including all House Bills in a booking and their latest Maximas-derived status.

- Delivery Order (DO) worklist: DOs awaiting pre-check; ability to mark “DO Checked” per House Bill.
- Under-bond verification worklist: House Bills marked under-bond awaiting verification; ability to mark “Under-bond Verified”.
- Exceptions/Overrides worklist: ability (for authorised roles) to allow booking without required DO and record the override.
- Ability to mark a booking as “Processed” once validations are complete and goods are good to be picked up.
- Storage fee flag visibility (informational; payment managed outside).
- FOC rebooking capability for selected staff roles.

7.5 Dashboard: Gatehouse (Read-only)

- Daily roster of bookings for the site.
- Basic list filtering/search expected (e.g., by booking reference or truck rego) where available.
- No portal actions required.

7.6 One-off Booking (No persistent dashboard)

Known requirement states that one-off bookings for general public occur via a URL without a dashboard. If the project requires “dashboards for all personas”, the one-off model needs confirmation.

8. Open items (decision pending at signoff)

- Data source for the parties not confirmed yet, method of sourcing the data unresolved.
- Tier-2 freight forwarder data sourcing and relationship establishment per House Bill is unresolved.
- Exact milestone list and terminology set to be displayed in dashboards needs confirmation.
- Refund/partial cancellation handling is unresolved and likely offline in Phase 1.
- Fee method for some fees (flat fee vs percentage) needs business decision.
- Whether one-off users remain “no dashboard” or receive a lightweight dashboard/status experience is not confirmed.
- How frequently Maximas updates can be reflected in portal and what “latest status” means operationally (update cadence) requires discovery.